
4. Attractions and Architectural Highlights

What to look for at each stop

Where Kota Meets the River

Kota, evening of Day 2

- Chambal riverfront beside the palace
- Kota Barrage, built in 1960, next to the palace walls
- Evening light over the river

Kota Museum: A Royal Life in Silver and Paint

Kota, Day 3

- Miniature paintings, Kota's best-known art
- Silver furniture and royal howdahs
- Hunting trophies
- Photographs of the royals with British dignitaries

Kota Fort: Elephants, Mirrors and Hunting Scenes

Kota, Day 3 (starred in our plan)

- Hathian Pol, the gate topped by rampant elephants
- Baradari with views over the complex
- Mirrorwork in the durbar hall
- Well-preserved hunting-scene paintings in the upper apartments
- Thick outer walls built by Dewan Zalim Singh in the early nineteenth century

Gepernath: A Waterfall Over a Shiva Lingam

Near Kota, Day 3

- Gorge-side Shiva shrine with a natural stream over the lingam
- A staircase of about 300 steps into the gorge
- A natural pool used by devotees for bathing
- Best seen in the monsoon, though access is restricted then

The Baroli Temples: Stone Poetry of the Pratiharas

Rawatbhata, Day 3

- A sanctum, a vestibule and a pillared hall in each temple, topped by a curved latina spire
- Shrines to Shiva, Vishnu, Mahishasuramardini and Ganesha
- Ghateshwar Mahadev, the largest temple, with its open pillared hall
- Local sandstone: some temples well preserved, others in ruins; ASI looks after the complex

Rana Pratap Sagar Dam: Power from the Chambal

Rawatbhata, Day 3

- 53.8 m masonry gravity dam
- 172 MW of hydropower
- Supplies cooling water to the nearby Rajasthan Atomic Power Station
- Reservoir views

Chuliya Falls: The Monsoon's Best Show

Gandhisagar side, Day 4

- Chambal falling over rock formations
- Fullest from July to September
- Quiet surroundings

Padajhar Waterfall: Green Pools on the Chambal

Gandhisagar side, Day 4

- Small but scenic fall
- Greenery and natural pools
- Easy to combine with Chuliya Falls

Gandhi Sagar Dam: A Landmark of New India

Gandhisagar, Day 4

- 62.17 m high dam on the Chambal
- Power station with five 23 MW turbines (115 MW)
- Reservoir feeding the Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary, notified in 1974

Chambal Sunset Point: Golden Hour on the Reservoir

Gandhisagar, Day 4

- Reservoir and backwater views at dusk
- Cliffs with nesting vultures and cliff swallows
- Boat safaris on the Chambal

Dharmrajeshwar: A Temple Carved Down Into the Hill

Chandwasa, Day 4

- Main structure about 50 m long, 20 m wide and 9 m deep, with seven small shrines around it
- Carved top-down like the Kailasa temple at Ellora
- Reached through a long sloping passage cut into the rock
- One of only two surviving rock-cut Nagara-style Hindu temples from before the 14th century
- A cluster of 51 Buddhist caves nearby; on India's UNESCO tentative list

Holkar Chhatri: A Memorial to a Maratha Warrior

Bhanpura, Day 5

- Memorial built on the site of his death, 1814–1841
- Marble statue of Yashwant Rao Holkar
- Small museum of Mandsaur's folk art inside

Bade Mahadev: A Waterfall Shrine Near Bhanpura

Bhanpura, Day 5

- Pilgrim shrine
- Waterfall (height reported locally at about 70 m, unverified)

"Mini Goa" at Gandhi Sagar: Beach Vibes on the Chambal

Gandhi Sagar, Day 5

- Beach-like lakeshore on the reservoir
- Tented stays at the Gandhisagar Forest Retreat
- Jet skiing, kayaking and motor boating

Kakuni: Ruined Temples With a Story

Kakuni, Day 5

- Group of ruined temples, state-protected
- Remains of Vaishnava, Shaiva and Jain shrines
- Sculptures displayed at Kota and Jhalawar museums